

Yisong Brian Wang

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EDUCATION

Peking University, the School of Economics, Beijing, China

PhD Economics, *expected* Jun 2026.

Committee: Xuezheng Qin (Chair), Christopher Davis, Eric Shi, Julie Shi, Zenan Wu, Castiel Zhuang.

ibid. first-year BSc Economics, Jun 2016 (Grades: 3.9/4, #1).

University of Oxford, Institute of Population Ageing, Jesus College, Oxford, the UK

Academic Visitor, joint training PhD program, Apr 2025.

University of Glasgow, the Adam Smith Business School, Glasgow, the UK

MRes in Theoretical Economics, Jun 2021. (Adam Smith Scholarship, Advisor: Hervé Moulin).

University of Cambridge, the Faculty of Economics, Trinity College, Cambridge, the UK

BA Hons., MA in Economics, Jun 2019. (Jardine Scholar; Trinity College Senior Scholarship. Advisor: Rupert Gatti).

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Welfare & Public Spendings, Digital Economics, Labour & Health Economics, Empirical IO, and Applied Micro.

WORKING PAPERS

Causal Evidence the Non-linear Relation between Health Literacy and Healthcare Spending R&R, IHFE

This paper develops a model of health literacy and simulates the value function along the accumulation path. We use Double Machine Learning, Orthogonal Random Forests, and B-spline-based semiparametric and nonparametric estimators to flexibly recover the spending-literacy gradient. We apply NLP techniques to build individual IV for causal interpretation.

JMP: Health Literacy as Structural Instrument for Improving Healthcare Efficiency Under review, QJE

This paper studies the different risk attitude displayed in health decision compared to financial decisions. We develop a structural model of the hospital decision process and employed computational methods to estimate both the absolute risk aversion coefficient and the moral hazard displayed during the process. Health literacy is introduced as information friction.

Data-driven Digital Health Technology, Effective Labour Supply, and Economics Growth Under review, JEDC

This paper develops a novel endogenous growth model incorporating digital health technologies and health-related data. We show digital health technology can offset the economic drag from population ageing. Theoretical and numerical results highlight the key roles of data permeability, health literacy, and policy interventions.

Digital Access and its Impact on the Elderly: An International Comparison Under review, JPA

This paper studies the influence of using digital health technology in improving the health. We use harmonized data from China's CHARLS and the UK's ELSA and apply PSM to identify the impact of digital access and usage, highlighting cross-country differences and policy implications.

A Dynamic Life-cycle Model for Health literacy as Human Capital: Theory R&R, Economic Science

This paper theorized and quantifies the impact of health literacy in a dynamic Grossman style life-cycle model. The model is solved using policy function iteration and simulated under a calibrated parameterisation disciplined by Chinese microdata on health, literacy, and medical spending. We then derive comparative statics for ageing, income, and subsidies. (in Chinese)

Health Literacy and Hospital Choice in China's Tiered Medical System R&R, China Health Economics

This paper examines how health literacy shapes hospital choice and medical spending within China's tiered medical system, combining rich survey microdata with quasi-experimental variation in access and information. (in Chinese)

RESEARCH IN PROGRESS

"Labour Synergy, Physician Shortage and Productivity in NHS England" Funded: University of Oxford, 2025

"Pension, Health Investment and of Labour Market Entries/Exits" Funded: University of Oxford, 2025

"Adaptive Behaviours under Climate Change: Blue Economy and Fishery Industry" Funded: PKU Belt & Road, 2024

"The Cooperative Core of Guarantees in Fair Division of Tasks" Received *Adam Smith* award at Glasgow, 2022

POLICY RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

IMF China Office, Asia & Pacific Department

International Monetary Fund, 2025 –

Economist, Reporting to Marshall Mills

IMF working paper: Digital Exports and Re-exporting to the UK and the EU under U.S. Trade Tariffs. This paper quantifies how Chinese firms use digital platforms and re-export channels, especially re-exports to the UK to mitigate the impact of U.S. trade tariffs, using detailed customs microdata and firm-level outcomes. Conducted various research on Customs (Trade) and Public Spending in China.

Oxford IARU-AHL network at Oxford Institute of Population Ageing

University of Oxford, 2024 –

Early Career Researcher

Participated in research on pension in the UK and in China.

PKU Belt-and-Road Initiative Research Team to South Pacific Island Countries

Fiji & Samoa, 2024 –

Economist, Certificated in *International Organization Professionals & International Communication Program*

Book Chapter: Climate Change and Blue Economy (Chapters 13 & 14), forthcoming 2026. The volume examines climate change and the blue economy in South Pacific Island countries under the BRI framework. My chapters analyse how climate change focusing on the fisheries sector and adaptive behaviours.

China International Capital Corporation

Peking University, 2023 –

Investment Analyst, Joint research project with Peking University School of Economics

White Paper: Digital Health in China: Theory, Current Situation, and Future Development. I lead the economic modelling section and work on empirical section, linking digital-health adoption to growth opportunity and digital economy.

PKU Research Centre for Market Economy

Peking University, 2022 –

Economist, Participated in Natural Science Foundation Project

Book Chapter: Natural Science Foundation Project (Chapter 3 & 7), first draft compiled, to be published 2026-27. My chapters develop the theoretical framework that embeds health literacy into a human-capital and health-production model, and lead the empirical analysis using national CFPS data and a new PKU health-literacy survey to identify causal mechanisms and non-linear effects on healthcare spending.

TEACHING

New York University Shanghai, Department of Data Science, Computer Science, and Engineering 2021 – 2022

Lecture Associate, Data Structures & Natural Language Processing. (reporting to: Keith Ross)

University of Chicago-Peking University Joint Summer School, School of Economics

2023 – 2025

Lead TA, International Policy Action Lab-Applied Econometrics & Programming in Stata

Other Teaching Assistant roles alongside study / by targeted audience of the courses since 2017

Undergrad: Programming for Economists, Linear Algebra (PKU), Intermediate Micro & Macro (Cambridge)

Master: Computational Macroeconomics, Mechanism Design, Cooperative Game Theory (Glasgow, Received

Adam Smith Business School Graduate TAs of the year, University of Glasgow)

PhD: Advanced Microeconomics (Glasgow), Advanced Econometrics (PKU), Sustainable Development &

Economic Policy (PKU-AIIB joint course)

UNIVERSITY SERVICE

Coordinator, School of Economics Labour and Health Econ. Seminars

PKU, 2024 & 2023

Convener, *Adam Smith Tercentenary* Seminar-Beijing Session

University of Glasgow & PKU, 2023

Panellist, the 5th & 12th *La Jeunesse* Young Economists Seminar

PKU, 2023 & 2016

RESEARCH ASSISTANT

Research Assistance for Professors: projects for labour matching in computational macroeconomics, wealth inequality in the UK and OECD countries, stable bilateral matching in US college admission.

Computer skills: Extensive programming experience including GPU (CUDA) coding, Cloud deployment, Python, MATLAB, C, Stata, Julia, Linux Bash, R, SQL, HTML, Java; L^AT_EX, Markdown, Gitlab, GitHub, GPT/LLM tuning (Huggingface, Modelscope, llama-factory) Queries, MS Office

English proficiency: Bilingual (GRE: V161 Q169 A4.0), Certificated translator (CATTI certificate). Translated and annotated Bloom et.al. (2020) invited by Jilin Univ. Published a piece on Bayesian learning for a popular science journal.

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

Oxford University Press - CUFE Conferences on Digital Economics	CUFE, Nov 2025
International Alliance of Research Universities Annual Conference-ALH Session	PKU, Oct 2025
International Health Economics Association Biannual Conference	Balli, Sep 2025
China-UK & -Europe Economics Association Annual Conference	University of Glasgow, Aug 2025
China Labour Economists Association Annual Conference	Changchun, Jul 2025
Centre of Health Economics-Health Economics Study Group	University of York, Mar 2025
International Alliance of Research Universities-Ageing Longevity & Health	Oxford University, Oct 2024

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Spotlight: Ernst & Young LLP, Audit and Assurance Department London & Shanghai, 2021

Audit Associate I, Retail, Consumption, Property & Transportation Division

Audited a multinational transportation company with 100+ subsidiaries and warehousing operations across China and Europe; conducted consolidated financial reviews under IFRS, including intercompany eliminations and complex worksheet tracking; performed detailed process walkthroughs on inventory, logistics, and fixed assets; supported cross-border coordination and contributed to final audit reporting.

(Qualified ACCA professional with international audit and reporting experience.)

Bureau of Economy & Information Technology, Shijingshan District

Beijing, 2023

Research, Digital Economy and Private-Public Partnership (PPP) Office

Research and fieldwork for the district's Digital Economy White Paper, synthesizing industrial surveys, enterprise interviews, and policy analysis into actionable insights; collaborated with local PPP offices to assess digital infrastructure readiness and propose strategic development guidelines.

Shengang Securities Co., Ltd., Investment Banking Division

Shanghai, 2022

Investment Analyst Intern ABS & Credit Bonds

Assisted in prospectus drafting, financial statement checks, shareholder tracing, AML screening, and ongoing ABS pool/cash-flow simulations for transactions such as 21 Meizhi 01/02 by developing Selenium-based automation tools.

British Business Bank

London, 2020

Investment Analyst Intern, Wholesale Solution

Engaged in research-focused support for evaluating the Furlough Scheme – a critical fiscal tool for protecting SME livelihoods. Collaborated with the bank's Policy & Research team to clean and validate 10k+ rows of SME furlough data, standardizing variables (e.g., firm size, sector, claim duration) to enable robust analysis of fiscal policy reach. Applied thematic coding to qualitative SME feedback, identifying key pain that hindered policy uptake.

Jardine Lloyd Thompson Insurance

London, 2017

Quant Analyst Intern, Risk Department

Hedged London Metal Exchange copper price risk and supported client quotes by maintaining forward-curve tables that rolled cash and three-month benchmarks into monthly pricing points. Fitted a simple volatility smile for each expiry and produced daily valuation packs for vanilla options and Traded Average Price Options on the monthly average price.

Jardine Matheson Group, Group HR Services

Hong Kong, 2016

Jardine Scholar & Pension Analyst Intern

Conducted research on strategic asset allocation for the Group's defined-benefit pension schemes, with a focus on China debt market and part of A-share exposure. Assisted with performance and risk monitoring of pension portfolios, and supported compliance teams on pension product features and regulatory requirements.